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ATTRACTION: Ancient Nalanda University Ruins

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Not Mentioned

LOCATION:

Nalanda

DISTRICT / REGION:

Nalanda

CATEGORY:

Historical Site / Heritage Site

OVERVIEW:

The Ancient Nalanda University Ruins showcase the remnants of the world's earliest residential international university. Established in the 5th century CE, it was the erstwhile center of global education and Buddhist learning. Today, it is Bihar's second World Heritage site and a sought-after destination for archaeologists, historians, and tourists.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Built in red brick, the expansive ruins exhibit ancient stupas, viharas, and educational complexes. Originally covering a very large area, the university accommodated about 2000 teachers and 10,000 students of Buddhism. It reached the zenith of perfection in education and architecture during the periods of the Guptas and Palas. Detailed accounts of its grandeur were mentioned in the writings of the famous 7th century CE Chinese traveller Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang).

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

Nalanda was the core of famous religions like Buddhism, Jainism, and Hinduism. The Gupta kings, Pala kings, and Harshavardhana were great patrons of this ancient city. It shone as a revered seat of Buddhism and an inspiration for quality in education worldwide.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

Not Mentioned

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Bihar's second World Heritage site.
- Ruins of a 5th-century CE international university.
- Accommodated 2000 teachers and 10,000 students.
- Built in red brick, featuring stupas and viharas.
- Mentioned by 7th-century Chinese traveller Xuanzang.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

Not Mentioned

Opening Hours:

Not Mentioned

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Not Mentioned

Accessibility Information:

Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

Not Mentioned

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Jay Prakash Narayan International Airport (Patna)

Distance From Airport:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Railway Station:

Nalanda and Rajgir Railway Station

Distance From Railway Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Distance From Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Road Connectivity:

Nalanda is well connected by road. Bus and Taxi Services can be used to reach here.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Police Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Medical Facility:

Not Mentioned

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Archaeological Museum
- Zuafardih
- Sarilchak
- Mustafapur
- Ruins of Telhara
- Mahamaya Place (Jagdishpur)
- The Xuanzang Memorial Hall
- Rajgir (about 15 km away)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

Not Mentioned

HOTELS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL GUIDES:

Not Mentioned

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

Not Mentioned

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The university was patronized by Gupta, Pala, and Harshavardhana rulers.
- Supported 10,000 students and 2000 teachers.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

The Ancient Nalanda University Ruins form Bihar's second World Heritage site. Established in the 5th century CE, this red-brick complex was the world's earliest residential international university, housing 10,000 students and 2000 teachers. Patronized by Gupta and Pala kings, it was extensively described by 7th-century Chinese traveller Xuanzang. It is accessible via Patna Airport and Nalanda/Rajgir railway stations.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known as the ruins of the world's earliest residential international university from the 5th century CE and is a World Heritage site.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in Nalanda.

Q: How many students and teachers did it accommodate?

A: It accommodated about 10,000 students and 2000 teachers.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: Visitors can arrive via Patna Airport and Nalanda or Rajgir railway stations.

KEYWORDS:

Ancient Nalanda University, Nalanda Ruins, World Heritage Site, Buddhist Learning, 5th Century CE, Xuanzang, Hiuen Tsang, Guptas, Palas, Red Brick Ruins, Buddhist Circuit.

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